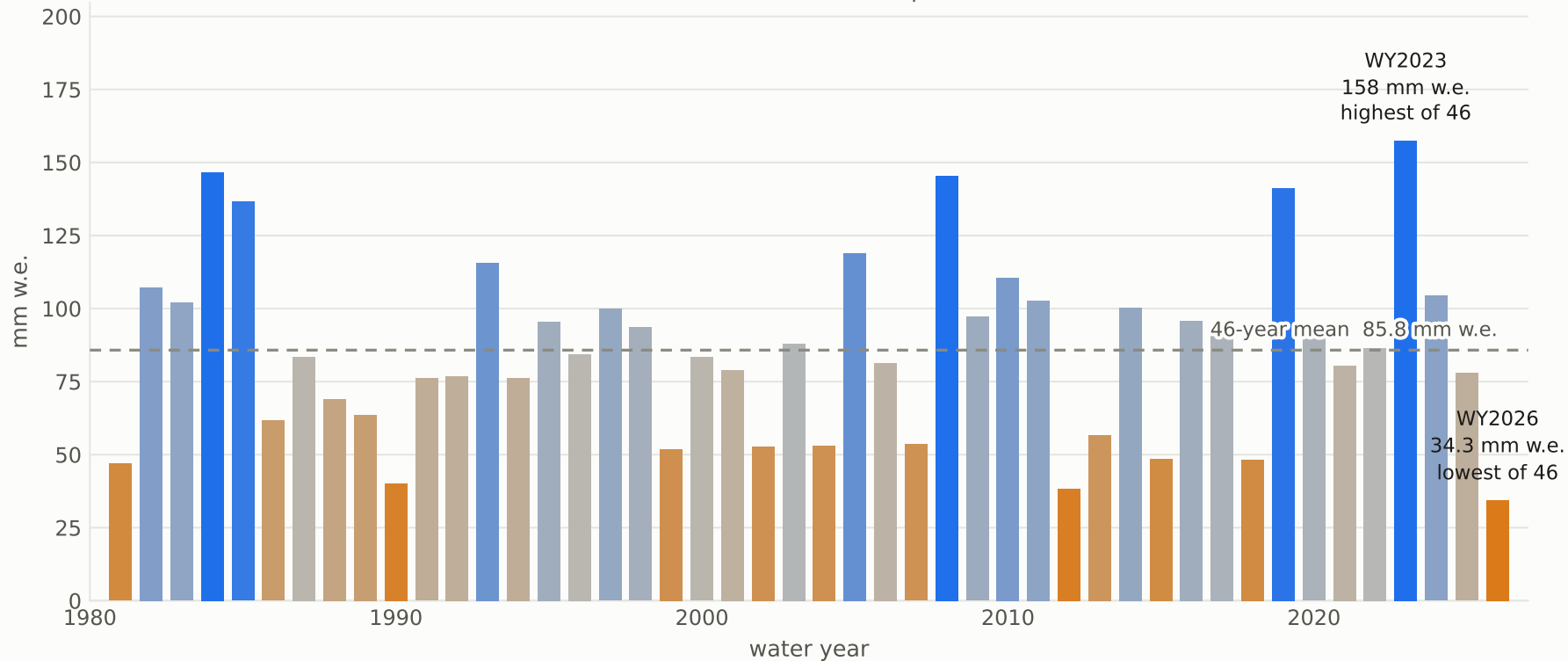


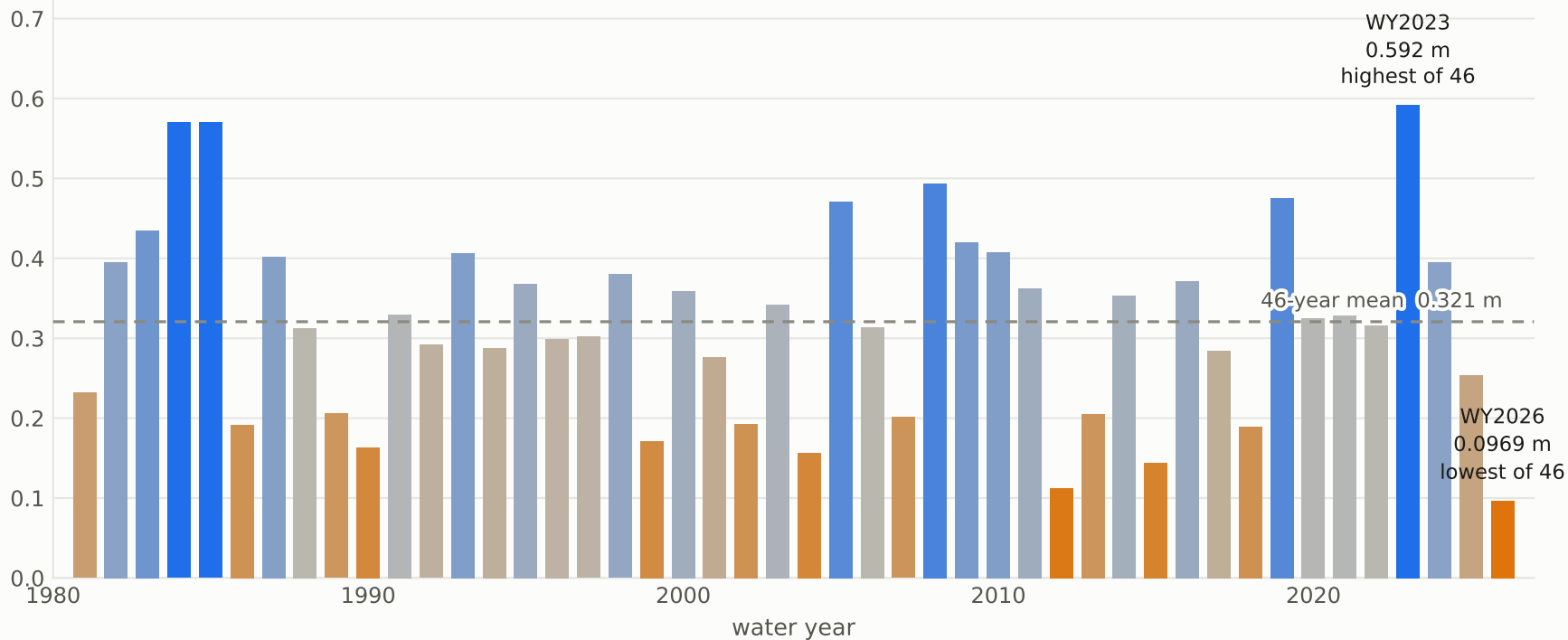
Colorado 1 April snow water equivalent, ERA5

Domain-mean over 72 MERRA-2 cells, WY1981-WY2026. Colour shows departure from the record mean.



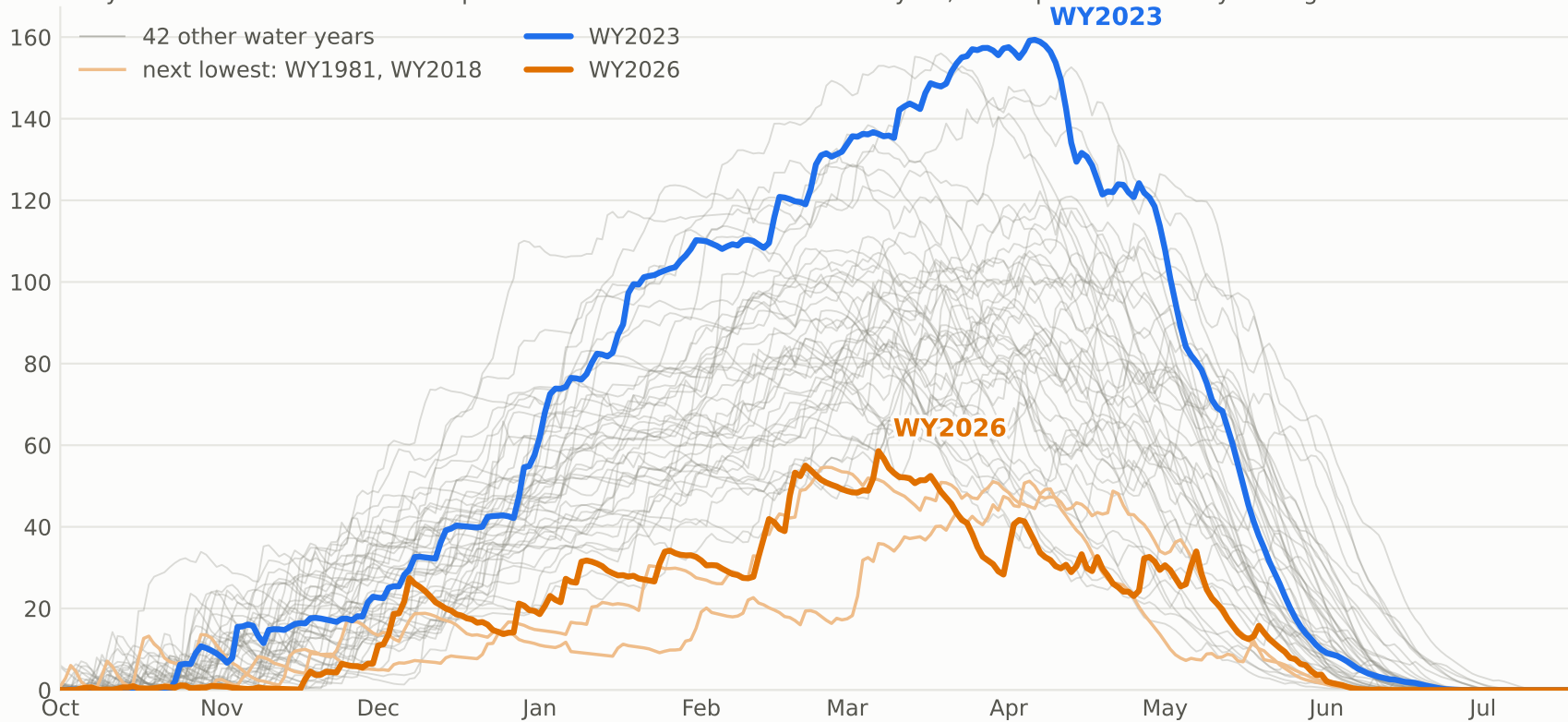
Colorado 1 April snow depth, ERA5

Grid-cell mean geometric depth, WY1981-WY2026. A sharper signal than SWE: the low year's snow was also less dense.



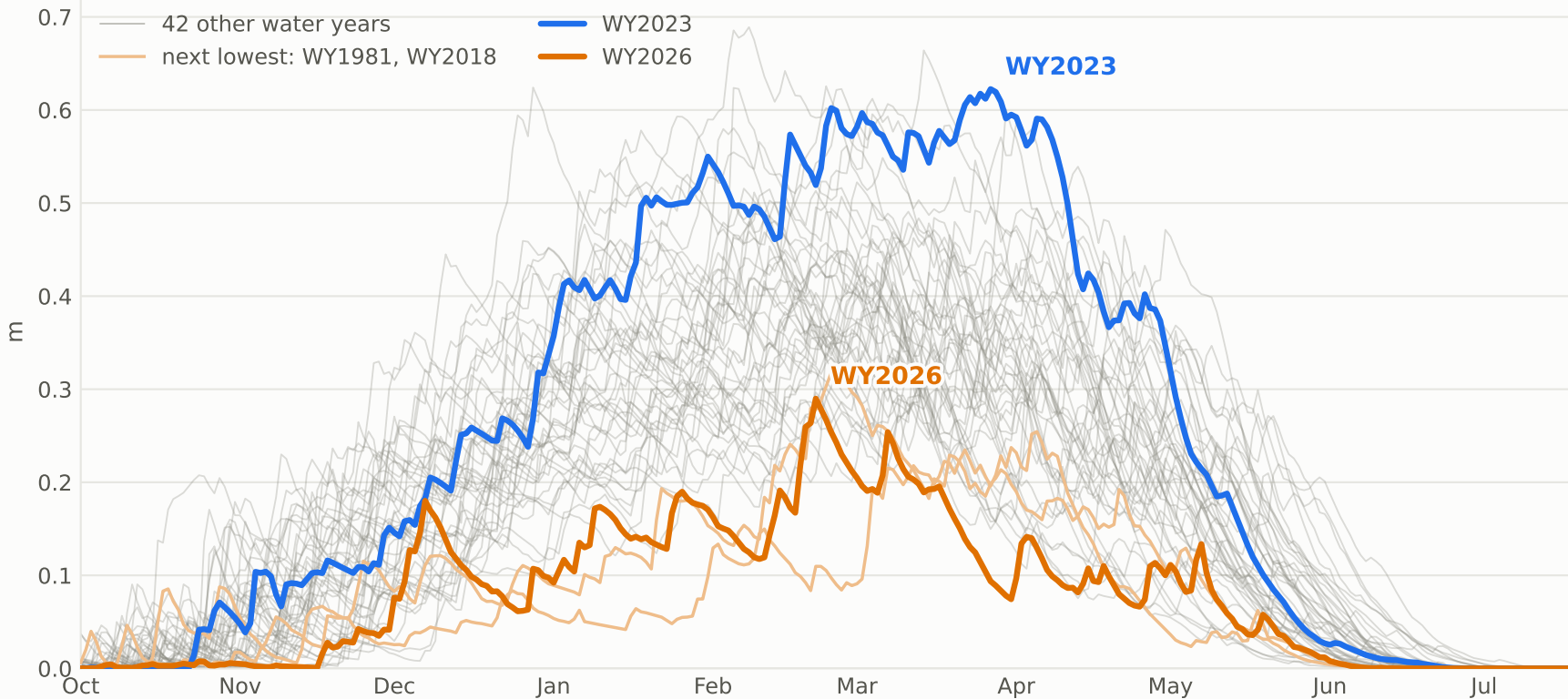
Every Colorado water year since 1981, ERA5

Daily domain-mean snow water equivalent. Each thin line is one water year; overlap shows where years agree.



The same years, as snow depth

Grid-cell mean geometric depth. The low year separates further here than in water equivalent, because its snow was also less dense.



Satellite validation, water year 2023

Domain-mean fractional snow cover. MODSCAG is the observed reference; ERA5's fraction is diagnosed, not archived.

